ARTICLE 30. To see if the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from free cash or available funds, or otherwise provide a sum of money to support a feasibility study investigating potential avenues for the refurbishment, replacement, or demolition of the Sanborn Carriage House located at 15 High Street in the Town of Winchester. The funds are to be expended under the direction of the Superintendent of Schools for the purpose of hiring a professional consultant or contractor to assess the current conditions of the Sanborn Carriage House structure, develop proposals for potential renovations or demolitions of the structure, provide cost estimates related to these renovation or demolition proposals, and explore the impacts of these proposals on the Ambrose School, Sanborn House, surrounding neighborhoods, nearby traffic flow patterns, and broader Winchester community; or take any other action in relation thereto.

(School Committee)

MOTION: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town appropriate a sum of $50,000, including $19,463.32 from the surplus remaining from free cash appropriated for Carriage House Consulting (Acct #0398942, A28 FTM 11/21) and $30,536.68 from available free cash for the purpose of contracting with a professional consultant or contractor to conduct a feasibility study investigating potential avenues for the refurbishment, replacement, or demolition of the Sanborn Carriage House located at 15 High Street in the Town of Winchester.

BACKGROUND: *The Sanborn Carriage House is a historic asset located at 15 High Street on the Ambrose Elementary School campus in the Town of Winchester. In 1907, the Sanborn Carriage House was constructed alongside the main Sanborn House as part of the hilltop estate of Oren Cheney Sanborn and his wife Lorena Armstrong Sanborn. Today, the property is currently under the care and control of the Winchester School Committee.*

In an effort to repurpose and refurbish the Sanborn Carriage House, the Winchester School Committee brought forward a $5.9M proposal at the 2022 Winchester Spring Town Meeting to renovate the property and house the Winchester Public Schools Central Office. This proposal was voted down by Town Meeting Members.

During the 2025-2026 school year, the Winchester School Committee brought forward a proposal to demolish the Sanborn Carriage House in response to community concerns about the building's deteriorating condition and to prioritize capital investments in other, student-facing school assets. At the 2026 Winchester Spring Town Meeting, Town Meeting Members voted down this proposal to fund the demolition of the Sanborn Carriage House.

Following Spring Town Meeting, community members and school parents have raised concerns to the Winchester School Committee regarding the best path forward for the Sanborn Carriage House property. This article aims to provide reputable evidence and insight that can help the broader community select the best potential path(s) forward for the Sanborn Carriage House.

Majority Vote Required